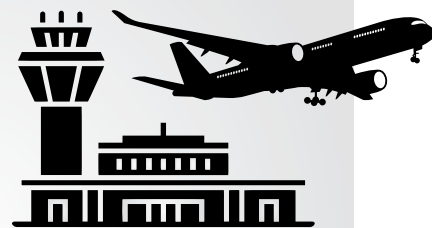




THE ADANI AIRPORTS

8 TOTAL AIRPORTS

(Ahmedabad, Jaipur, Lucknow, Guwahati, Mumbai, Navi Mumbai, Mangaluru, Thiruvananthapuram)



₹9,267

**CRORE
REVENUE
(2024-25)**

94.4

**MILLION
PASSENGERS
(2024-25)**

10.8

**LAKH TONNES
CARGO
(2024-25)**

getting passengers who use foreign airports as transit points. If India's airports can offer more slots, efficient transit scheduling, competitive pricing for airlines, and stronger connectivity, its key airports could evolve into regional transit hubs.

Experts say at full capacity, NMIA and NIA are expected to emerge as regional hubs for transit passengers, like Dubai, Singapore, and Doha, where travellers from multiple cities land before heading to their destinations. "NMIA's integrated terminal layout allows for smooth international and domestic transfers, complemented by advanced baggage handling and dedicated transfer corridors. The combination of infrastructure and regulatory alignment will help NMIA strengthen India's position as a preferred global aviation gateway," says a spokesperson for NMIA.

India is now one of the world's largest and fastest-growing aviation markets, which makes a strong domestic origin and destination (OD) base available to feed a hub. "IATA and industry data show India's market has been growing strongly and is among the top three by originating OD traffic. That makes a hub strategy commercially plausible provided transfer traffic economics and policies are aligned," says Mayur Patel, head of Asia with data specialist OAG Aviation.

Patel says once fully developed, both the airports are designed to match the capacity of major global hubs such as Dubai and Doha. However, this goal will be realised over multiple phases spanning decades, he adds.

"Unlike single-city hubs (Dubai International Airport, Hamad International Airport) that serve very large transfer populations across Africa/Asia/Europe, Navi Mumbai and Noida compete with established home hubs (Mumbai/Delhi) and must win transfer traffic by offering better connectivity, shorter transfer times, or airline commercial incentives. Local catchment (Mumbai and Delhi NCR combined) gives them large origin/destination demand, a key ingredient many hub airports rely on," he adds.

However, some aviation experts say it is too ambitious to assume that NMIA and NAI will whisk away traffic from global airports in just a few years. A lot will depend on how domestic airlines can attract passengers, now served by foreign airlines, with smart routing and incentives. They say the present capacities of these airports are less than New Delhi's IGI which, with three terminals and four runways, is expecting 140 mmpa passengers in another decade. Its present capacity is 100 mmpa. "I think NMIA will need more capacity. I